

LING 102 section week 2 (2/9)

Yvette Yi-Chi Wu

1 Practice

(1) Identify the ambiguities below by showing the two possible bracketings:

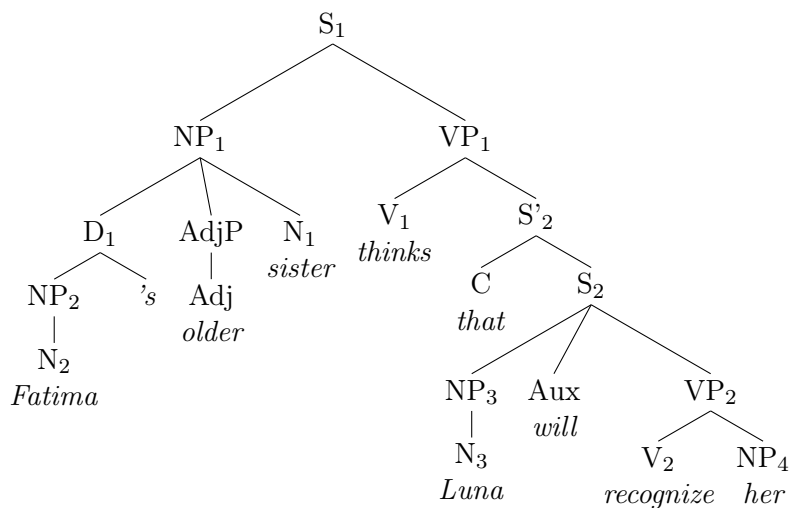
- the American history professor
- there is a bird in the cage that is blue
- unlockable (can you try it on a word?)

2 Structural relations

Several useful terms to describe the relationships between different constituents:

- precedence:** α precedes β iff α is linearly ordered to the left of β
 - dominance:** α dominates β iff α contains β
 - c-command:** α c-command β iff 1) α and β do not dominate each other, and 2) the first branching node that dominates α also dominates β

(3)

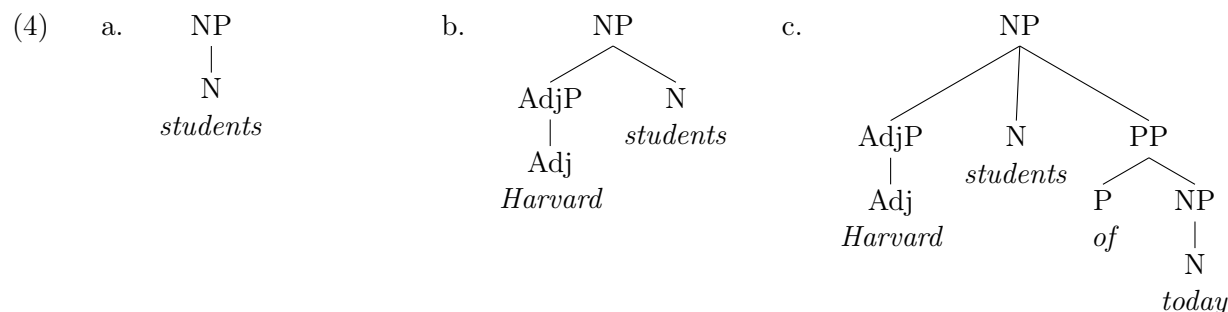


- list the nodes that dominate S_2
- list the nodes that c-command NP_4
- does NP_3 c-command NP_4 ? what about NP_1 and NP_2 ?

3 Heads and phrases

A **head** refers to an individual word, whereas a **phrase** is (or can be) made up of multiple words.

For example, the subject of a sentence is an noun phrase NP, which can be as simple as one word (e.g. *we*, *Max*, *students*) or be a complex phrase (e.g. *the child that I saw yesterday at the store*). This means that phrases will sometimes branch into further nodes or sometimes just be a head.



Heads and phrases are different in terms of their distribution and function in the grammar.

- (5) Looking at the trees above, answer the following questions:
- what rules can apply to an N head but not an NP phrase?
 - what rules can apply to the NP phrase but not an N head?

4 Tense, aspect, and modality (TAM)

There are three big inflectional categories that often occur in English as auxiliaries:

- (6) a. **tense**: describes the relationship of the Utterance Time (U) to the Reference Time (R)
 b. **aspect**: describes the relationship of the Event Time (E) to the Reference Time (R)
 c. **modality**: the possibility of an event depending on several factors of evaluation

